

University of California, Irvine

International Programs

Present Perfect Progressive

Part 1: Practice with Form—Use the verb in parenthesis to make a sentence or clause in the present perfect progressive tense.

1. (clean) Judy _____ her house for an hour, but much still remains to be done.
2. (work) I _____ tirelessly for several days, and I need a break.
3. (handle) The students _____ the stress and demands of studying very well.
4. (train) Jake _____ for her next swimming competition, so she hasn't been around much.
5. (dwindle) Lily's enthusiasm _____ lately; I fear that she may not be motivated anymore.
6. (contemplate) Lately, Bob _____ moving to Australia, but he hasn't made any decisions yet.
7. (discuss) A: Do you know if they chose a candidate for the position yet?
B: No, but they _____ it for quite some time now, so they must be getting close.
8. (toss around) Did you know Melinda _____ the idea of quitting her job and moving to Spain?
9. (get) You can tell that autumn is near; it _____ darker earlier.
10. (disturb) Diego's loud neighbors _____ his sleep every night with their incessant socializing.

Practice 2: Present Perfect and the Present Perfect Progressive—Sometimes it can be tricky to decide between using the present perfect or the present perfect progressive. In the following examples, please choose one of three options: (a) present perfect, (b) present perfect progressive, or (c) either (both are correct).

1. Jodie and Karen _____ each other for over seven years.
(a) have known (b) have been knowing (c) both are correct
2. We _____ for five hours! Can we please take a break soon?
(a) have worked (b) have been working (c) both are correct

3. A: Why are your eyes so red?

B: Because I _____ at a computer screen.
(a) have stared (b) have been staring (c) both are correct

4. A: Why is Danny late?

B: Because he _____ his keys yet.
(a) hasn't found (b) hasn't been finding (c) both are correct

5. A: Jane looks beautiful!

B: I agree! I think it is because she _____ regularly.
(a) has worked out (b) has been working out (c) both are correct

Practice 3: Right or Wrong? Decide whether the underlined clause is grammatically correct or incorrect for the context. Then correct the mistake if it is wrong.

1. I don't know what's wrong with me! I have been so clumsy. I have been dropping my keys for no reason lately.

2. A: What's taking you so long? Please unlock the car so I can get it in and turn on the air conditioning!
B: Sorry, I'm looking for my keys. I've just been dropping them.

3. Jan and her friends have been going to the beach several times already this summer.

4. I am sorry I haven't been available to spend much time with you lately. I've been studying English grammar on Coursera.

5. The economy have been improving since the new law passed.

6. The company will likely lose all of its best employees because the director is been expecting too much of them lately.

7. Our dogs get so exhausted after going on a walk. They have been resting ever since we returned from the park.

8. The lawyer had been lying to everyone in the court since this trial began.

9. I think I may have to decline your invitation to join you for dinner. I've been spending too much money lately and I need to be more frugal.

10. I can't believe that Gabby has been going to sleep by 9:00 every night; she must be exerting a lot of energy throughout the day!